A3 Problem-Solving

Work through one problem on one sheet: understand it, find the root cause, test countermeasures and make the fix stick.

Reflect & Improve · A3 Thinking (Toyota) · Plan · Do · Check · Act · Inspired by John Shook, Managing to Learn

PROBLEM _____

OWNER _____

DATE _____

1 Background

PLAN · WHY THIS MATTERS, AND TO WHOM

2 Current Condition

PLAN · FACTS, DATA OR A SKETCH, NOT OPINIONS

What's happening now? Go and see the work, then draw or chart it.

Sketch, chart or stickies

The measure today: _____

3 Goal

PLAN · WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Target: _____ By when: _____

We'll measure it by: _____

4 Root Cause

PLAN · ASK WHY UNTIL YOU REACH A CAUSE YOU CAN FIX

Why 1? _____

Why 2? _____

Why 3? _____

Why 4? _____

Root cause: _____

5 Countermeasures

DO · SMALL CHANGES THAT TACKLE THE CAUSE

COUNTERMEASURE	WHICH CAUSE IT TACKLES	EFFORT S/M/L

6 Plan

DO · WHO DOES WHAT, BY WHEN

WHAT	WHO	WHEN	DONE?

7 Check

CHECK · DID IT WORK?

Result against the target: _____

What we learned: _____

8 Follow-up

ACT · MAKE IT STICK, OR TRY AGAIN

- [ ] Make it the standard way of working
- [ ] Share it with teams who have the same problem
- [ ] Try another countermeasure
- [ ] Close the A3

Share with: _____

"What's really happening, and have we gone to see it?"

"Which cause, if we removed it, would stop the problem coming back?"

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